

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.12. 15th April 2024



OUR REFLECTION TODAY IS

“SALT WITHOUT LIMIT”.

Taken from the passage of scripture of Ezra 7:20-22

Ezra 7:20-22

20 And anything else needed for the temple of your God that you may have occasion to supply, you may provide from the royal treasury.

21 Now I, King Artaxerxes, order all the treasurers of Trans-Euphrates to provide with diligence whatever Ezra the priest, a teacher of the Law of the God of heaven, may ask of you—

22 up to a hundred talents of silver, a hundred cors of wheat, a hundred baths of wine, a hundred baths of olive oil, and salt without limit. NIV



- Recently I was drawn to this phrase “SALT WITHOUT LIMIT” as it seemed to have some significance particularly in the light of all the other items and specific amounts that the King Artaxerxes prescribed to be made available for Ezra to rebuild the temple in Jerusalem.

- But salt was to be without limit.

“Salt without limit”. NIV

“An unlimited supply of salt”. NLT

“There is no limit on the salt”. The MESSAGE

“Salt without prescribing how much”. ESV, Webster, WEB

- So, it was left for Ezra to determine how much salt would be needed for the journey and the project that he was about to undertake.

■ EZRA'S BUDGET

IN ESSENCE THIS WAS EZRA'S BUDGET for the repair of the temple. He would have to complete the project with the amount that the king had made available to him.

■ A QUESTION FOR US

- What are your thoughts as to why it is stated that the amount of salt was undefined?
- Was it because it was of lesser importance compared with the other material possessions?

■ OUR SPEECH, CONVERSATIONS TO BE SEASONED WITH SALT – GRACIOUSNESS.

In Colossians 4:6, the Apostle Paul writes, “Let your speech always be gracious, seasoned with salt, so that you may know how you ought to answer each person.” Much of this text is captured in this aphorism: “Say what you mean, mean what you say, and never be mean when you say it.”

Colossians 4:6 Let your speech be always with grace, seasoned with salt, that he may know how ye ought to answer every man.

- COLOSSIANS 4:6 MEANS THAT WHEN WE SPEAK, RESPOND TO OTHERS THAT OUR CONVERSATION IS TO BE BOTH GRACIOUS AND SALTY.
- SALTY IN THE SENSE OF HAVING SUFFICIENT TASTE OR SAVOR TO PLEASE, INTEREST, FAVOURABLE AND MOTIVATING. (acceptable, pleasant, palatable, wholesome, honourable and proper)

- **THE OPPOSITE TO SALTY IS INSIPID which means BLAND, WEAK, WATERED DOWN & UNPALATABLE**
- CONSIDER for a moment what would happen if our speech was LIKE THAT, **ungracious** and **insipid (bland, weak, watered down and unpalatable)**.
- **INSIPID** means empty of qualities that make for **spirit and character** and implies a lack of **sufficient taste or savor to please and interest**. - LACKING IN **FLAVOUR AND INTEREST**
- **INSIPID** also suggests a lack of **liveliness, force, spirit and FLAT**, **implying** to things that have lost their **sparkle or zest**.
- The opposite of **INSIPID** is **being flavorful, pleasant** because when spices and salts are left out of food is usually considered **insipid**.
- **HOW DO WE SEASON OUR WORDS WITH SALT?**
- So that our speech is gracious and seasoned with **salt, expressing tolerance, thankfulness, and kindness**.
- So that we speak words of tolerance, Not Judgement
- Words of thankfulness, - Not complaint.
- Words of kindness, - Not bitterness.
- Words of 'welcome', Not reluctance and cautiousness
- Words of acceptance, - Not rejection.
- IT IS EASY TO FIND FAULT in others BUT IT IS MORE DIFFICULT to extend **GRACE** regardless of their weaknesses, faults and failures.
- **SALT IS USED TO ENHANCE TASTE. Job 6:6 (NIV)**
- "Is tasteless food eaten without salt, or is there flavour in the sap of the mallow?"*
- "Can that which is unsavoury be eaten without salt? Or is there any taste in the white of an egg?" Job 6:6 KJV*
- **When our speech is seasoned with salt we enhance and improve the reputation of others.**

- **COVENANTS – SEALED WITH SALT**
- God said covenants were to be sealed with **salt, meaning – given legitimacy and authenticity**.
- Every covenant sealed **with salt** must have the qualities of **sincerity, integrity, truthfulness, faithfulness (fidelity) and of an enduring nature**.
- **THE NEW COVENANT**
- All believers must always **keep in mind** that THE NATURE OF THE NEW COVENANT established by Jesus Christ **IS BASED ON GRACE, MERCY, FORGIVENESS AND ACCEPTANCE**, NOT ON REVENGE OR JUDGEMENT.
- NOTE: The blood of Jesus speaks of better things than the blood of Abel. Abel's blood cries out to **REVENGE**, **but Jesus' blood** cries out for something much better - **FORGIVENESS**.
- **Remembering this truth** will affect our speech and how we respond, answer others who might require help, healing, acceptance, direction, and guidance.
- **ACCORDING TO GOD'S WORD THERE SHOULD BE NO LIMIT TO THE SALT OF OUR SPEECH.**
- **THERE IS TO BE NO MEASURE OR AMOUNT OF LOVE AND FORGIVENESS, GRACE AND MERCY IN THE MANNER IN WHICH WE SPEAK ABOUT OTHERS AND SPEAK TO OTHERS.**
- **WE CAN NEVER SHOW TOO MUCH (SALT) KINDNESS, TOLERANCE, ACCEPTANCE TOWARDS OTHERS. NO LIMIT.**
- **WITH JESUS THERE WAS NO RESPECT OF PERSONS OR LIMIT OF LOVE, ACCEPTANCE AND KINDNESS SHOWN TOWARDS ALL PEOPLES, SINNERS AND SAINTS ALIKE.**
- **HE WAS KNOWN THE FRIEND OF SINNERS - Matthew 11:19 "... a friend of tax collectors and "sinners." NIV**
- Luke 7:34 Jesus ".... has the lowest sort of friends!" TLB*
- **LET US BE A PEOPLE WHOSE SPEECH IS SEASONED (IMPREGNATED) WITH THE SALT OF GRACIOUSNESS, KINDNESS AND FORGIVENESS TOWARDS THOSE PERSON WHOM WE ENCOUNTER EACH DAY.**
- **LET US BE SALTY CHRISTIANS - Amen – Ps Barry**